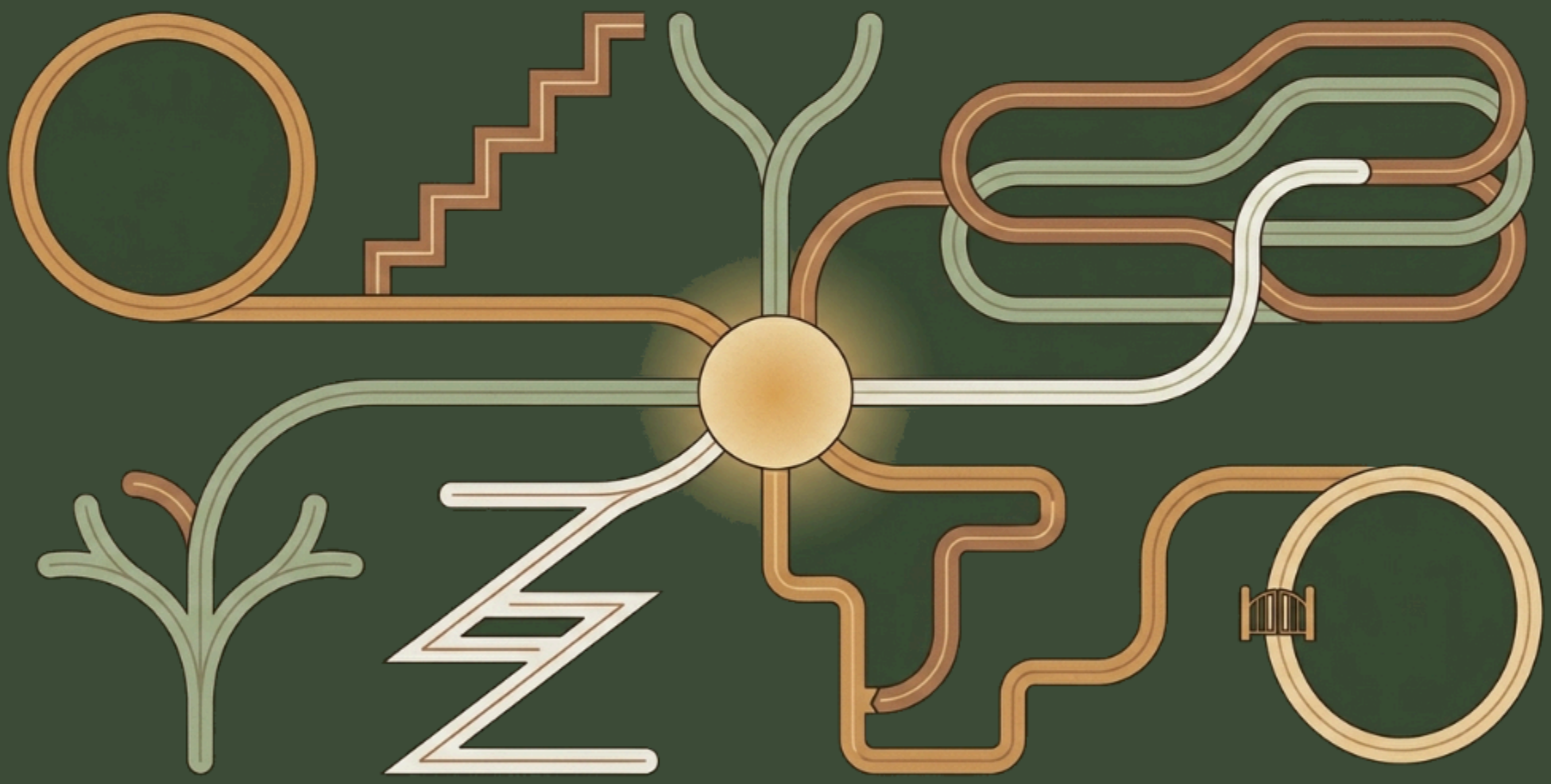
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ANATOMY OF AN AGENT

How an agent works through a job

Eight loop patterns. A publishing job for each.



THE EVERYDAY LOOP

1. Think, act, check

Reason about the next step, take it, look at the result, and repeat.

Use it when a reader asks an open question, and the agent has to look around before it can answer.



2. Step by step

A new chapter arrives

↓

Turn it into a summary

↓

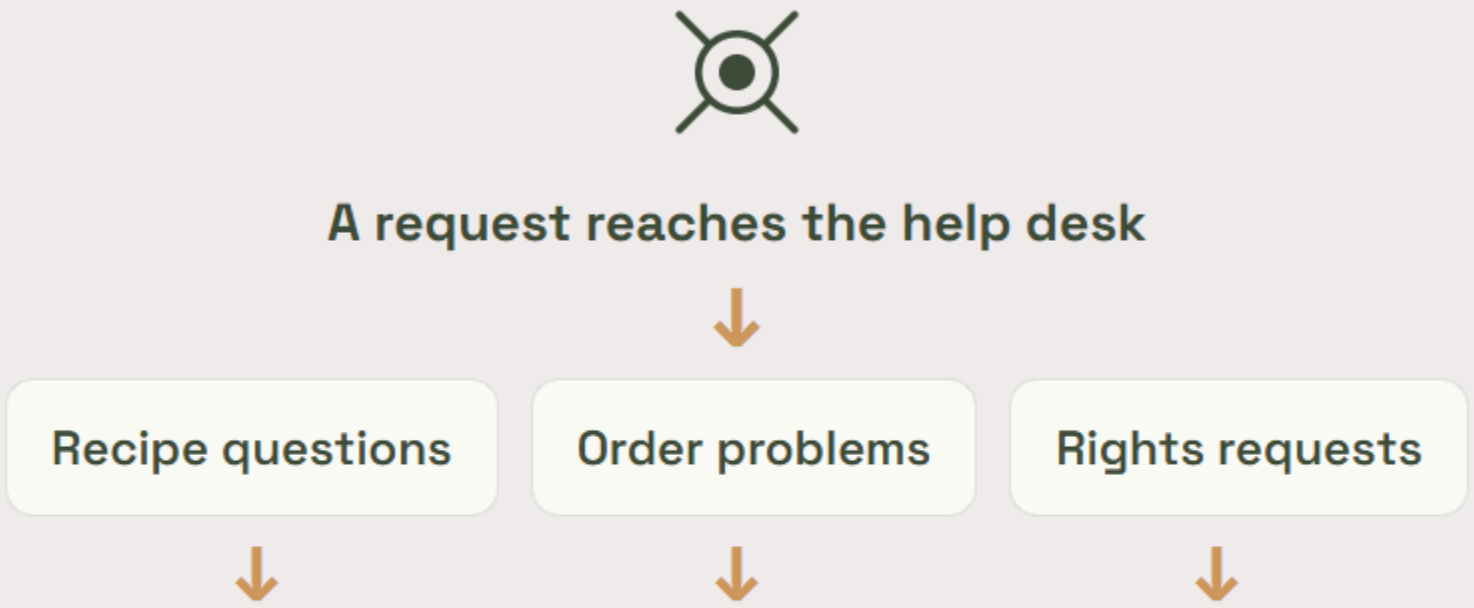
Check: stop here if it fails

↓

Turn the summary into a quiz

A fixed sequence of steps, with a check between them that can stop the run early.

3. Routing



Sort the request first, then send it down the path built for that kind of request.

SPLIT, THEN COMBINE

4. In parallel

Split the job into parts, work on them at the same time, then combine the results.

Use it when reviewing a long manuscript: every chapter is checked at once, then the notes are combined.



5. Manager and helpers

THE MANAGER

Picks the topics for the reading list

↓

THE HELPERS

Each helper researches one topic

↓

THE MANAGER

Assembles their work into the list

One agent breaks the job down, hands pieces to helper agents, and assembles their work.

6. Draft and critique



THE WRITER

Drafts the copy for the back cover.

Revises it on every note.

UNTIL IT PASSES



THE REVIEWER

Checks it against house style.

Sends it back until it matches.

One agent writes. Another reviews against the standards and sends notes until it passes.

7. Plan, then do

Write the whole plan first. Work through it. Re-plan when something changes.

1

Plan the chapters

The whole course pack is planned before any work starts.

2

Gather each one

The agent works through the plan, chapter by chapter.

3

Re-plan if a title is unavailable

A change rewrites the plan instead of stopping the job.

8. Ask a person

THE AGENT

Prepares a permissions request, then pauses.

↓

A PERSON

Reviews it and decides, before anything is acted on.

↙ ↘

APPROVED

The agent carries on and acts.

NOT APPROVED

Nothing is spent and no rights are granted.

Use it for anything that spends money or grants rights.

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“The best agents will leverage all of the different types of loops depending on the task at hand.”

Jonathan Woahn, CXO & Co-founder, Cashmere

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